THE LOOKING GLASS BEAUTY SCHOOL

A04 Practical Observation Assessment and Marking Sheet

Direct observation of a liquid-and-powder acrylic service on a suitable adult model: a full set or overlay, an infill and rebalance on at least one nail, and a removal on at least one nail. Twenty criteria; seven safety-critical (SC). Adapted from The CPD Group practical observation template.

Liquid and Powder Acrylic Enhancement CPD Course | Course author: Jessica Jane Preston | Version 1.3, November 2026

Learner name: _____ Model name/code: _____ Date: _____
Assessor: _____

Subject: preparation, tip or form, application in zones, refining and finishing on prepared natural nails; infill and rebalance on at least one nail and removal on at least one nail (a nail coated earlier in the day, or the model's existing coating where it can be identified). Product system (monomer, powder, primer): _____

Scoring each criterion: 2 = met to a professional standard without prompting; 1 = met with one prompt or a minor omission corrected on the spot; 0 = not met. Pass: 32 out of 40 overall AND every criterion marked SC scored at least 1 with the fault corrected, or 2. An SC criterion scored 0 is a fail regardless of the total; the learner may be re-assessed on a later date after further practice.

Health and safety and hygiene

Assessment criterion	Score 0 / 1 / 2	Assessor feedback and evidence seen
Work area set up clean and uncluttered; extractor, leads and plugs visually checked; lidded bin, dappen dish and waste arranged before the model sits down.		
SC Hands sanitised; single-use items used once and discarded; reusable tools decontaminated before and after; the blood or skin-break procedure followed if needed.		
SC Dust and vapour controlled throughout: extraction on for every filing and removal, the dappen dish lidded between beads, bottles capped, dust damp-wiped and never blown or brushed into the air.		

Consultation and planning

Assessment criterion	Score 0 / 1 / 2	Assessor feedback and evidence seen
SC Consultation completed on Form A; contraindications checked on every nail and the surrounding skin; the service refused or adapted where indicated; nothing suspicious covered; no fresh product over lifted product.		
Treatment plan agreed and explained: overlay or extension, length against the model's work and lifestyle, shape, finish, price, infills every two to three weeks, removal, aftercare; consent recorded.		
Product system identified from its Safety Data Sheet with the monomer named; no unlabelled product on the desk; the model told that warmth may be felt as product sets and to say so at once.		

Preparation, tip and form

Assessment criterion	Score 0 / 1 / 2	Assessor feedback and evidence seen
SC Free edge shaped with the finger supported; proximal fold pushed back gently; only loose, non-living cuticle removed; no		

cutting of living tissue; no filing into the lateral folds; plate de-shined with 240 grit or finer, not thinned; no electric file on the natural nail.		
Dust removed; plate cleansed; dehydrator and primer applied sparingly to the plate only; one hand prepared at a time.		
Tip selected sidewall to sidewall with the C-curve matched, adhesive in the well, blended on the tip only and cut to length before product; or form fitted with no gap at the hyponychium and the correct angle, checked from underneath.		

Application

Assessment criterion	Score 0 / 1 / 2	Assessor feedback and evidence seen
Bead picked up correctly: brush saturated and wiped on the lip of the dish, bead allowed to settle, placed not pressed flat, blended with the belly of the brush, no painting back and forth once the product begins to set.		
SC Mix ratio controlled throughout: beads hold their shape, no wet bead placed, no flooding of the folds or sidewalls; any product that reaches skin removed with the brush before it sets.		
SC A hairline gap kept at the proximal and lateral folds and at the hyponychium; no product, primer or monomer on skin at any point.		
Zones built in order: length and shape in zone 1, the structural bead over the stress area forming the apex in zone 2, the cuticle bead blended to a whisper-thin margin in zone 3.		
Structure checked from the side, the barrel and above before the product sets; product left to set fully (sounds hard when tapped) before any filing.		
Finished nails: apex in the back third, even C-curve, straight symmetrical sidewalls matched across all ten, no ledge at the cuticle margin or under the extension, free edge not over-thinned, surface smooth, dust removed, oil to the skin only.		

Infill, repair and removal

Assessment criterion	Score 0 / 1 / 2	Assessor feedback and evidence seen
Infill and rebalance on at least one nail: lifted product removed entirely, old apex reduced, regrowth blended with no ledge, exposed plate prepared, structure rebuilt with the apex repositioned.		
SC Removal on at least one nail: bulk reduced with a hand file to a thin layer, acetone soak with the skin protected, softened product slid off without force and re-soaked where it resisted; no prising, nipping, drilling or filing to the plate.		
Plate inspected after removal; light buff only if needed; cuticle oil and hand cream applied; any change noted and acted on before anything goes back on.		
Products, batches, tip or form, length and shape recorded on Form C; aftercare given verbally and the written handout supplied; the infill date agreed.		

Professional conduct

Assessment criterion	Score 0 / 1 / 2	Assessor feedback and evidence seen
Works within the agreed plan, explains each stage to the model, keeps the work area tidy throughout, and manages time so the set is complete and finished within the session.		

Result

Total score /40	All SC criteria met Y / N	Result: Pass / Re-assess	Re-assessment date if needed

Assessor feedback to the learner (strengths, and the one thing to work on first):

_____
_____
_____
_____

Learner signature: _____ Assessor signature: _____ Date: _____

Reasonable adjustments made to the assessment method (if any), with the competence and safety standards unchanged:

_____